

Role-Play Instructions

Copy the prompt cards. For each role play, assign role A and role B. Each student reads his or her prompt card. Give students a moment to prepare. Student A begins the dialog. Student B continues it. Students should not read cards after role-play begins. Students exchange cards and practice the role-play again in their new roles.

Version 1:

Have students work in pairs. Assign roles A and B to each student. Have each pair of students work with only one role-play per page or have students practice more than one role-play.

Version 2:

Work with an individual student. You play role A. The student plays role B. Switch roles.

Version 3:

Have students work in groups of three. One student plays role A. One student plays role B. The third student takes notes and gives feedback to the other students. Students alternate roles so each student plays role A, role B, and audience.

Lessons 1–4: Role-play prompts

1A Student A Imagine someone has told you that Student B just got a new job. You run into Student B. Ask about Student B’s experience.	1B Student B Imagine you have recently moved from an apartment to a house. Respond to Student A. Then change roles.
2A Student A Imagine you have a problem with a boss, teacher, advisor, roommate, or friend. Tell Student B the problem and ask for a suggestion. Respond to Student B’s suggestion.	2B Student B Respond to Student A. Make a suggestion for dealing with the problem. Then change roles.
3A Student A Imagine you run into Student B, whom you don’t know but who looks familiar. Use an expression for <i>Getting to know a person</i> to start a conversation.	3B Student B Respond to Student A. Imagine that you have met before, and remind Student A where. Then continue the conversation by asking about Student A’s job. Then change roles.
4A Student A Invite Student B to do something tonight.	4B Student B Respond to Student A. Politely decline Student A’s invitation. Then change roles.

Lessons 5–8: Role-play prompts

5A Student A Imagine you run into Student B, who looks familiar to you. Use an expression for <i>Getting to know someone</i> to begin a conversation.	5B Student B Respond to Student A. Imagine you have met somewhere before, and remind Student A where. Then use an expression for <i>Asking about a person's job</i> to continue the conversation. Then change roles.
6A Student A Invite Student B to do something tonight.	6B Student B Respond to Student A. Decline politely. Then change roles.
7A Student A Tell Student B about a false impression you had about a person in the past. Explain how you came to see that it was false.	7B Student B Respond to Student A. Summarize what Student A says. Then change roles.
8A Student A Tell Student B about your favorite online activity.	8B Student B Listen to Student A. Imagine that you are not interested in the online activity that Student A likes. Use expressions for <i>Expressing a lack of understanding</i> and <i>Expressing an opinion without offending someone</i>. Then change roles.

Lessons 9–12: Role-play prompts

9A Student A Describe your diet to Student B. Give detailed information and include any unusual facts. Give clarification when Student B asks for it.	9B Student B Listen to Student A and ask for clarification on one point. Then change roles.
10A Student A Think of a lifestyle improvement you have made. Use the expressions for <i>Giving reasons</i> to tell Student B about it.	10B Student B Respond to Student A. Use an expression for <i>Expressing approval</i> in your response. Then change roles.
11A Student A Think of something you spend too much time doing. Tell Student B about the last time you spent too much time doing it. Include an expression from <i>Talking about your lifestyle</i> and an expression from <i>Evaluating your lifestyle</i>.	11B Student B Respond to Student A. Then change roles.
12A Student A Imagine Student B is your roommate and doesn't turn off the lights, computer, or TV at night. Use an expression for <i>Persuading</i> to try to get Student B to change these habits.	12B Student B Respond to Student A. Then change roles.

Lessons 13–16: Role-play prompts

13A Student A Ask Student B about career goals. Use an expression from <i>Asking about ambitions</i>. Ask at least two follow-up questions.	13B Student B Respond to Student A. Use an expression for <i>Talking about ambition</i>. Respond to any questions. Then change roles.
14A Student A Imagine you are interviewing Student B for a job at an advertising agency. Ask three interview questions.	14B Student B Respond to Student A. Then change roles.
15A Student A Give Student B instructions on how to use an electronic device, a machine, or an appliance.	15B Student B Respond to Student A. Use two or more expressions for <i>Restating to show that you understand</i>. Then change roles.
16A Student A Imagine you are practicing giving a presentation about how to motivate employees. Student B is helping you practice by asking follow-up questions.	16B Student B Imagine you are helping Student A practice for a presentation on motivating employees. Listen to Student A, and ask follow-up questions. Then change roles.

Lessons 17–20: Role-play prompts

17A Student A Ask Student B to tell you about a personal fear. Use one of the expressions for <i>Asking about fears</i>.	17B Student B Respond to Student A. Describe one of your fears in detail. Include one of the expressions for <i>Talking about fears</i>. Then change roles.
18A Student A Talk about causes of stress that you have. Use at least one of the expressions for <i>Talking about causes of stress</i>.	18B Student B Respond to Student A. Include one or more expressions for <i>Giving advice by talking about your own experiences</i>. Then change roles.
19A Student A Tell Student B about a dream or wish that you have. Use one or more expressions for <i>Talking about dreams/wishes</i>.	19B Student B Respond to Student A. Use one or more expressions for <i>Expressing interest</i> and <i>Asking for reasons</i>. Then change roles.
20A Student A Ask Student B about a regret. Use an expression for <i>Asking about regrets</i>.	20B Student B Respond to Student A. Talk about one of your past regrets. Use an expression for <i>Talking about regrets</i>. Then change roles.

Lessons 21–24: Role-play prompts

21A Student A Tell Student B the plot of a movie you have seen and give your reactions to it.	21B Student B Respond to Student A. Then change roles.
22A Student A Describe a song you like to Student B. Use an expression from <i>Describing music</i>.	22B Student B Respond to Student A. Then change roles.
23A Student A Ask Student B about what kind of clothes are in style right now. Use an expression from <i>Asking about trends</i>.	23B Student B Respond to Student A. Include an expression from <i>Describing trends</i>. Then change roles.
24A Student A Tell Student B some surprising news. It can be personal news, school or local news, or national or international news. Use an expression from <i>Sharing surprising news</i> to introduce the topic.	24B Student B Respond to Student A. Use an expression for <i>Expressing surprise</i>. Then change roles.

Lessons 25–28: Role-play prompts

25A Student A Imagine you are working at a check-in gate at an airport. Student B is a passenger. Ask about any luggage to be checked, and tell Student B where to go next.	25B Student B Respond to Student A. Ask about your gate and ask if the flight is on time. Ask about food during the flight. Then change roles.
26A Student A Imagine you work at the check-in gate at an airport. Imagine that Student B is a passenger on a flight that has been canceled. Give Student B the bad news.	26B Student B Respond to Student A. Ask for help or advice. Then change roles.
27A Student A Imagine you are going on a trip to Mexico City with Student B. Suggest some alternatives for sightseeing, places to stay, and transportation.	27B Student B Respond to Student A. Give reasons for your choices. Then change roles.
28A Student A Tell Student B about two customs or appropriate behaviors in the U.S. You can talk about questions and conversation topics, greetings, dinner customs, gift-giving, or other topics.	28B Student B Respond to Student A. Tell whether the customs or behaviors are the same or different in your native culture. Then change roles.

Lessons 29–32: Role-play prompts

29A Student A Tell Student B about a sporting event or other event you saw or participated in recently.	29B Student B After Student A begins talking, change the subject. Then change roles.
30A Student A Imagine you heard about or saw a crime or accident. Tell Student B about it. Answer any of Student B’s requests for clarification.	30B Student B Listen to Student A. After the first sentence or two, interrupt to ask for clarification. Use an expression from <i>Interrupting to ask for clarification</i>. Then change roles.
31A Student A Tell Student B what form of advertising you think is the best. Use an expression from <i>Giving evidence to support your opinion</i>. Use an expression from <i>Giving examples</i> to support your opinion.	31B Student B Respond to Student A. Then change roles.
32A Student A Think about an issue in your school, community, city, country, or in the world. Ask Student B for an opinion on that issue.	32B Student B Respond to Student A. Politely give an opinion. Then change roles.